

November-December Teacher Pack

Nine print-ready pages for remembrance, children's rights, accessibility, Human Rights Day, gender-based violence prevention, and inclusive winter learning.

THE SHARED DIRECTION

**Notice the barrier.
Change the condition.
Share power. Check
what changed.**

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

Choose one pathway that fits your learners and local context. Use the scripts as starting language, keep authentic sources beside the material, offer several ways to participate, and protect privacy. Depth matters more than marking every date.

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NOVEMBER 8-11 | MORNING ANNOUNCEMENTS

Three days of broader remembrance

Short scripts for Indigenous Veterans Day and Remembrance Day. Read as written or adapt carefully for age and community context.

November 8 - Broaden the story

Today is Indigenous Veterans Day. First Nations, Inuit, and Métis people have served in conflicts, peacekeeping, and military roles across generations, often while facing unequal rights and discrimination at home. Remembrance asks us to learn individual stories, recognize contributions and sacrifice, and notice whose service has not always been equally honoured.

November 10 - Learn one life

Public history can become a list of dates unless we learn about people. Today, choose one Veteran's story from a reliable source. Notice the person's name, community, choices, relationships, service, barriers, and life after service. What does this story add to what you thought remembrance meant?

November 11 - Remember and work for peace

On Remembrance Day, we honour people who served and those affected by war. Our community may include Veterans, military families, refugees, peace activists, and people carrying recent experiences of conflict. We can hold these experiences with care while asking how listening, justice, diplomacy, human rights, and collective responsibility help build peace.

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

Veterans Affairs learning resources
<https://www.veterans.gc.ca/en/remembrance/classroom-materials/learning-resources>

NOVEMBER 20 | K-7 LESSON SHEET

Children's rights in everyday school life

A 30-45 minute National Child Day lesson that moves from naming rights to changing school conditions.

Learning intention

We can recognize children as rights-holders, notice how school conditions support or limit rights, and recommend one change that makes a right easier to experience.

Open - 5 minutes

Read one child-friendly right. Ask: What would we see, hear, or feel in a school where this right is genuinely protected? Students may speak, draw, write, point, or pass.

Audit - 20 minutes

Choose one right connected to learning, play, safety, culture, family, access, rest, health, or voice. Record: where is this right already visible; what barrier can make it harder to use; who holds responsibility; and what change could help?

K-2: use picture rights and concrete examples. Grades 3-5: distinguish wants, needs, rights, and adult responsibilities. Grades 6-7: add an intersectionality check - who could still be excluded by the proposed solution?

Act, measure, and care

Choose one realistic recommendation. Name what evidence would show that participation, access, safety, or voice improved. Revisit the change in two weeks.

Use public observations and optional anonymous input. Do not ask students to reveal a private rights violation. Make private help routes visible and follow school procedures for any disclosure.

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

UNICEF Canada National Child Day
<https://www.unicef.ca/en/national-child-day>

Child-friendly Convention
<https://www.unicef.org/child-rights-convention/convention-text-childrens-version>

NOVEMBER | FAMILY MESSAGE

National Child Day at Walnut Road

Copy-ready language for a newsletter, email, or class update.

Copy-ready message

On November 20, our class will recognize National Child Day by learning about the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child. Students will explore how rights such as learning, play, safety, culture, family, access, rest, health, and participation appear in everyday school life.

Our goal is not only to name rights, but to ask what adults, institutions, resources, relationships, and routines help every child experience them. Students will identify a school strength and recommend one realistic improvement without being asked to share private experiences.

Families can continue the conversation by asking: Which right did you study? Who has responsibility for protecting it? What change could make it easier for more children to use?

Teacher note

Keep the authentic source linked beside the copied message. Replace class-specific details as needed without changing the rights-holder framing.

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

UNICEF Canada National Child Day
<https://www.unicef.ca/en/national-child-day>

DECEMBER 3 | K-7 LESSON SHEET

Accessibility is something we design

A 30-45 minute barrier audit for International Day of Persons with Disabilities or any time.

Learning intention

We can identify barriers created by environments, formats, routines, and attitudes, then test one change that makes participation easier for more people.

Notice - 8 minutes

Choose one ordinary task: entering a room, reading a sign, joining a game, hearing instructions, completing a worksheet, using a website, moving between activities, or asking for help. Ask who may have to work harder and why.

Audit - 15 minutes

Check the task through physical, sensory, communication, cognitive, digital, social, and attitudinal lenses. Record one existing strength, one barrier, and one possible redesign.

Do not simulate disability. Use disabled people's public expertise and voluntary input rather than asking a classmate to speak for everyone.

Redesign, test, and revise

Make the change small enough to test: clearer contrast, plain language, tactile or visual cues, movement choice, predictable steps, captions, quiet access, flexible timing, or another route to participate. Gather evidence before and after, then revise.

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

Classroom Accessibility Allies
<https://www.rickhansen.com/Accessibility-Allies>

Rick Hansen resource library
<https://www.rickhansen.com/schools-communities/resource-library>

DECEMBER 6 | TEACHER CARE GUIDE

Remembrance, prevention, and care

Age-appropriate framing for the National Day of Remembrance and Action on Violence Against Women.

Purpose

December 6 remembers the 14 women killed at École Polytechnique in 1989 and calls Canadians to act against gender-based violence. The classroom goal is dignity, prevention, help-seeking, and safer systems - not graphic retelling.

Age-appropriate entry points

K-2: body autonomy, fair treatment, boundaries, safe adults, and getting help. Do not introduce massacre details.

Grades 3-5: challenge gender stereotypes, practise respecting boundaries, interrupt harmful language, and identify trusted adult support.

Grades 6-7: name the day's history carefully; examine how stereotypes, harassment, racism, colonialism, ableism, poverty, homophobia, and transphobia can shape harm and access to help; connect remembrance to prevention.

Care and safeguarding

Give content notice, avoid graphic images and details, never invite personal disclosure, and do not position girls or women as responsible for preventing violence. Make private help routes visible and follow school safeguarding procedures for any disclosure.

One systems-change question

What message, routine, reporting pathway, adult response, or school condition could change so everyone's boundaries, safety, voice, and future are treated as equally important?

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

Government of Canada December 6 overview

<https://www.canada.ca/en/women-gender-equality/commemorations-celebrations/16-days/national-day-remembrance.html>

DECEMBER 10 | K-7 LESSON SHEET

From a right on paper to a right in practice

A 30-60 minute Human Rights Day lesson and gallery activity.

Learning intention

We can explain what people, relationships, resources, rules, and decisions are needed for a human right to be genuinely usable - not only formally promised.

Open - 5 minutes

Choose one right and ask: What turns this promise on paper into an experience people can actually count on? Collect examples without asking for personal disclosures.

Create - 20 minutes

Pairs make a rights-in-action card: name the right; show a school, local, or world example; identify a barrier; name who holds responsibility or decision-making power; and propose one change to conditions.

K-2: draw one right and the people who help protect it. Grades 3-5: connect rights to adult and institutional responsibilities. Grades 6-7: add an intersectionality check and distinguish formal equality from lived access.

Connect and act

Build a class gallery that shows how rights depend on one another. Choose one local example to investigate further using public evidence, authentic voices, and the question: whose power or responsibility can change the condition?

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

United Nations Human Rights Day resources
<https://www.un.org/en/observances/human-rights-day/resources>

Child-friendly Convention
<https://www.unicef.org/child-rights-convention/convention-text-childrens-version>

DECEMBER | MORNING ANNOUNCEMENTS

Three mornings toward Human Rights Day

Brief scripts connecting dignity, systems, access, and action.

1 - Rights belong to everyone

Human rights belong to every person because every person has dignity. Rights are not rewards for good behaviour and do not depend on identity, ability, language, religion, income, family, or popularity. Today, notice one right you can see being protected at school.

2 - Equal words do not always create equal access

A rule can sound the same for everyone while creating different barriers. Fairness asks who has to work harder, whose needs were assumed, and what the environment can change. Today, notice one routine that offers more than one way to participate.

3 - Rights need people and systems

A right becomes real through relationships, resources, rules, public decisions, and people who accept responsibility. For Human Rights Day, ask: What condition could we improve so more people can participate, be heard, learn, feel safe, and belong?

Care note

Announcements should open learning, not replace it. Pair these scripts with a classroom conversation, a child-friendly rights source, and one practical action.

DECEMBER | FAMILY MESSAGE

Making room for many winter experiences

Copy-ready language for a newsletter, email, or class update.

Copy-ready message

As winter approaches, our class will learn about the many ways people mark - or do not mark - this time of year. We may encounter Hanukkah, Winter Solstice, Christmas, Kwanzaa, and a wide range of family, cultural, religious, seasonal, and personal experiences.

We will use community-created sources, recognize diversity within traditions, and avoid asking any student to represent a culture or faith. Activities will offer meaningful ways to participate or opt out, and our focus will be respectful curiosity rather than costumes, reenactments, or assumptions about what families celebrate.

Families are welcome to share a reliable public resource, book, or community voice they value, but no one is expected to disclose or teach a private or sacred practice. Thank you for helping us create a season of dignity, care, and belonging for every student.

Teacher note

Check dates and wording against the official Surrey Schools Equity, Diversity and Belonging Calendar. Offer several meaningful participation routes before a student has to request one.

TRUSTED STARTING POINTS

Official Surrey Schools EDB calendar

<https://media.surreyschools.ca/media/Default/medialib/surrey-schools-edb-calendar-2026-27.aabfef204060.pdf>